PLACEMENT PREPARATION

Summer Placements – Product Management 2020 Edition



SIGMA - The Product Management & Technology Club

IIM BANGALORE

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PRODUCT/PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

Microsoft

Designation	**Program Manager Intern**
Job Description	As the in-house advocate for the millions of people worldwide who use Microsoft products, you drive the technical vision, design, implementation and market success of next-generation software solutions. As the CEO of your product components, some of the questions which you would be addressing through your role are: • What customer problem I am addressing? • What product solution do I craft to address this gap? • How do I deliver the best customer experience possible? • Does the product solution meet the business need (revenue, brand, etc.)? • How do I take the product from conceptualization to launch? • How do I work with marketing, and various sales channels to drive adoption?
Roles & Responsibilities	The role entails the following three distinct aspects: ***Defining and executing product strategy and roadmap***: Defining who the product is for, identifying the fundamental problem that we are solving, understanding the competition, and our core positioning with respect to the competition, identifying our approach to the market and partnerships. ***Building the Product:*** Lots of white boarding, storyboarding, sketching and designing, iterating with engineering on trade-offs between priority/timelines/capabilities, partnering across teams in Microsoft to deliver the solution, performing usability studies, planning versions, legal, marketing, monetization plans etc. ***Connecting with the customer:*** Evangelizing product through customer connect, being the 'face' of the product, experimentation and data analysis, iterating on feedback and learnings.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Group Activity + Interview
Candidates selected	7

Experiences

Alex Biswas

Workex: 36 months, Design Engineer, ARM
Education Background: EEE, NIT Surathkal 2013-17

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Mininum 12 months of workex was necessary, but no such restrictions on domain of work ex. I am from an EEE background with three years of work ex in VLSI. I wasn't very familiar with coding, but that didn't seem to matter.

PM Topics Covered: App Critique, Product Design, Product Strategy, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)
Ans: Resume submission, a GD, and one/two interviews. 20-25 were shortlisted for interviews, and seven got in.

GD: It was not a conventional discussion, each group of 10 was given a topic and every individual was sent into a separate breakout room. They were supposed to prepare a product solution for the problem statement issued and mail it in 20 min. I got the topic of "Digital Assistant for Students"
Based on the submissions, the shortlists and hotlists were released the next day.
For me, there were two rounds of interviews.

Round 1(50 mins): The various questions asked were

- Tell me about yourself
- Reason for interest in PM role
- Favourite product- I chose Spotify.

Then there were questions about the App

- What about Spotify makes it great?
- If I had to change one thing about Spotify, what would it be?

I started with the customer base that Spotify has in India, an approximate idea of their motivations for using the app. And then looking at the user journey starting from Registration to Song Discovery to features such as recommendations and Playlists for customized experience. I followed CIRCLES and went through the following process

1. User Personas
2. Needs
3. Feature Suggestions
4. Prioritization based on Value delivered, effort needed
5. Key Metrics

Then, there were the following questions:

- To Tweak the current revenue model of the company to accommodate and monetize the feature

- The Interviewer grilled me on the various trade-offs of such a feature and asked me to propose a marketing strategy and guesstimate the user conversion from the free to the premium version

Round 2(30 mins): It was another Case-based Interview; I was asked to design a Social Media App for Kids.

- The various users of such an app (age groups or economic backgrounds)
- Identify their needs and identify other stakeholders such as Parents and Content creators for such a Social Media App.
- Grilled me on various pain points such as Security for such an App, a few technical questions on improvement of security, various ways of ensuring it is user friendly, and trade-offs of the same.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans: Product design and improvement questions, light guesstimates. Minimal HR questions were asked to me.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans: Decode and Conquer and Cracking the PM interview. I also referred the PM Sigma process and IIMA's Prodman Book. A bit of practice through mock cases on product design, critique, and product improvement cases is recommended.
Have a holistic understanding of any physical product of the company as well. Group discussions are helpful, helps in gaining varied perspectives on a particular case.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans: Remain calm, think aloud, structure your thoughts. Practice CIRCLES on various products. More than the final solution, the interviewers seemed to be more interested in the approach taken in solving the case. Keep your Interviewer involved while solving the case. Be thorough with your resume and the products of the company that you are applying for.

Shantanu Agarwal

Workex: 36 months, Software Engineer, Oracle
Education Background: B. Tech (EE), IIT BHU, Varanasi

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?

- Won't say there were any restrictions.
- But relevant work-ex certainly helps.
- However, even if you don't have CS background, you can crack the interview process. You just have to show your interest in Tech.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. First round was kind a case submission. They called it GD. A group of students were given a design question. Each one had to solve that individually and submit a word doc. An interviewer was there on call to discuss the approach and clarify the doubts. Time Limit – 30 mins.
Interview rounds and their details?
Had 2 rounds of Interview question

1. First round – Tell me about yourself and a design question (Design an app for children so that they can socialize virtually during the lockdown). For the design question, approach was important.
2. Second Round – Typical HR. Why Microsoft? What do you do in free time? Why? Was asked what do you think about Oracle Cloud?

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. No resume-based question.
HR questions in 2nd round
Design question in 1st round

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. For prep, I read the two books that are recommended everywhere.
Cracking the PM interview and Decode and conquer. Apart from that, I solved couple of design questions online randomly.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Understand the PM process. Who is PM? What do they do? Why do they do what they do?
How does a PM solve a design question? How to critique a product? How to suggest improvements?

Ajay Parthasarthy

Workex: 24 months, Amadeus Software Labs, Software developer
Education Background: B.Tech, Electronics and Communication Engineering, VIT Vellore

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. There weren't any work-ex restrictions. I remember even people who had worked in consulting companies got shortlisted. However, a significant percentage of the people who got shortlisted were engineers who had work-ex in software.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, App Critique, Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Microsoft had a GD round. However, it was not a GD but a Product design question. We were asked to design a "Digital Assistant for students to help with their

education needs". I followed the CIRCLES method for the same, and followed the following process:

- Objective
- User personas
- Customer Needs
- Features
- Prioritization
- Success Metrics

We had to complete this within a time frame of 30 minutes. We were put into individual breakout rooms to do this task. A member from the recruiting team would enter the breakout room to check the progress that we had made and would suggest what we should focus on. I remember making a point about Microsoft's "Meeting room insights" for which the recruiter seemed intrigued and had a good 2-3 minute discussion about it. So, this is actually a good time to grab the recruiters' attention to try and show how well you have thought about the design and what you actually want to convey with the design document that you have written.

Interview rounds and their details?
There were 2 interview rounds. The first was purely technical. The second was a mixture of resume-based questions and a few technical questions.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. My first interview had two parts. First was a case and second was a discussion on my favourite app and one feature that I would like to add to it.
The case was *"You are the data engineer of a big retail chain across the country. You see one day that the number of transactions has taken a hit by 20%. What data would you look at to understand the reason?"*.
Next was a discussion on my favourite app which I mentioned as Cricbuzz (a news app which tracks live cricket scores). He wanted to know the features that I liked the most and the features that I would want to improve in the app. Following that, he wanted me to describe a feature that I wanted to add. I mentioned that I wanted to add a player compare feature where we could compare the statistics of say a Steve Smith and a Virat Kohli.
The second interviewer started off by asking me about my work experience and specifically asked about a point in my resume where I had mentioned that I worked on Cloud and CI/CD. After that he asked me about Uber's pricing model and the cross network effects exhibited by Uber.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Cracking the PM interview, resources from Sigma and TryExponent, and online resource.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Keep asking questions during the interview. A PM should be able to ask the right questions. Also, for preparation, do read the cases in Competition and Strategy well. A lot of concepts that are covered in that course would help you, such as network effects, economies of scale etc.

Chandana Velaga

Workex: 35 months, Software Engineer, Cisco
Education Background: B. Tech (CSE), NITK Surathkal

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Min. 12+ months required

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy,

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. There is a GD for the shortlisted students (not an actual GD where you have to fight for your voice to be heard! :P). It is an individual assessment of a product design question. The entire group is given a common question. Post that you must drop off and login to another call where you will be assessed by an evaluator. You are expected to list down your approach and ideas in a word doc and submit that at the end of 30 mins. The 30 mins flies like a breeze, trust me!
GD Question: Design Linkedin for blue collar jobs
Interview rounds and their details?
Interview Round 1 – went for about 30 mins

1. How will you do dynamic pricing for airplane tickets
2. Design a loyalty program for Bing

The interviewers will guide you all along. Just keep thinking out loud following a structured approach.
Interview Round 2 – another 30-40 mins

1. Design a social networking app for children
2. If you can design any product that you want, what would it be?

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans Depends on the interviewer. In my interview, they jumped straight into design-based case questions and no HR questions were asked.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Solve product design cases with friends. Read Decode and Conquer, try to follow a few tech news. Exponent (YouTube channel) has a few great PM mock interviews. Be prepared about the products of the company that you are going to interview with. Take a couple of products and come up with top features that you like and improvements. While doing this, try to cover an app from each sector (ex: Swiggy in the food delivery space, Paytm in Fintech space, Amazon/Flipkart in e-commerce space).

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Interviewers are primarily looking for a structured answer and not the final solutions. While there are existing structures like CIRCLES, do create a custom structure for yourself (based on all the materials you've referred to). Keep solving cases and be very thorough with basic questions like favorite product, product that you do not like, how would you improve it etc.

Amazon/ AWS Consulting

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	Intern must be customer obsessed and possess strong analytical skills, exceptional communication abilities and a strategic mind-set. Candidate must be a team player and bring experience working with cross-functional teams. Prior experience in consumer internet space or in the financial services or payments space is preferred. This role is responsible for working with the worldwide Amazon team to formulate recommendations on new business initiatives and partnering with operations, technology teams, and product development teams to implement these recommendations. As a product manager, you will develop long-term strategies to offer customer-centric features and programs,and ensure quality onsite customer experience and overall service. The ideal candidate will be enthusiastic about managing challenging, lengthy projects across multiple teams and locations. He or she will be comfortable marshalling large amounts of data to make decisions and build business cases. We are looking for a Product Manager who shares Amazon's passion for the customer— someone who understands the importance of compelling features and functionalities in driving great customer experience.
Roles & Responsibilities	Define and drive a world-class customer experience. Create alignment for the product vision. Translate the customer experience into a logically sequenced and optimized product roadmap. • Partner with global category leaders to establish selection strategy of brands and products, and work with global vendors to add selection to the global catalogue. • Maintain a product and feature roadmap and manage prioritization and trade-offs among customer experience, site performance and operational support load.

	• Proactively identify and resolve strategic issues that may impair the team's ability to meet strategic, financial, and technical goals. Lead cross-functionally to ensure we implement the business vision efficiently. • Own ongoing and continuous improvement of the customer experience and defect reduction for all products. • Prepare business cases for category-specific initiatives targeted at improving category experience and partner with the appropriate cross-functional teams to deliver them.
Focus and Deliverables	• Identify and prioritize the most immediate improvement opportunities. • Benchmark competitive experiences across the customer value chain, and define and implement a roadmap of improvements that ensure Amazon leadership for each of these. • Create and implement a roadmap that ensures leadership in customer experience in each business category. Roles and Responsibilities
Process	Online simulation assessment + Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	7(Amazon) + 5(AWS)

Experiences

Nikita Udupa (Amazon)

Workex: 2 years in Oracle Financial Services Software as an Associate Consultant
Education Background: Electronics and Communication Engineering, NIT Jamshedpur

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No, there were no such restrictions.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. A common online assessment of 60-90 minutes for all roles, like a simulation/psychometric test. No GDs or case submissions or tests that required preparation.
Interview rounds and their details? 2 Interview rounds, both eliminative. Took around 1.5 hours (including waiting time).

Round 1:

- Interviewer asked about background, hobbies, then asked a product design question related to my answers. I mentioned reading as a hobby, so he asked if I use any product or service for books and then asked me to design features for that service.
- Follow-up questions based on my answer such as success metrics, etc.
- Questions based around Amazon leadership principles. "Can you tell me about a time you displayed bias for action/had to dive deep."
- Practice product design questions, go through every step of your answer and show your thought process, product design question can be based on hobbies/interests or your work ex. – similar questions. I was asked what I had worked on in my previous work experience. Then I was asked a product design question for an insurance service/app.
- One guesstimate about 2 wheelers in India.
- Another question based on leadership principles.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Mostly product design and HR questions based on leadership principles. Metrics to measure success was stressed on in both rounds. 1 guesstimate in 2nd round. Resume related question was just an introduction, they did not go through my resume in detail.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Cracking the PM interview, Sigma frameworks for product design questions, ICON frameworks for cases/guesstimates.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Practice product design questions, go through every step of your answer and show your thought process, product design question can be based on hobbies/interests or your work ex.

Tejal (Amazon)

Workex: 4 years as a software developer with Aricent & Ciena
Education Background: B.Tech Computer Science (Amity University)

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Majority of the shortlisted candidates had relevant work-ex.

PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy, App Critique, Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Online simulation assessment (90 mins)
Interview rounds:
Interview was conducted in two rounds which collectively lasted for around 50 minutes.
Round 1 – 20 mins (Interviewer: an IIMA alumnus)
Started with introduction

Question – What goes behind Facebook making friend suggestions?
Some behavioural questions
Round 2 - 30 mins
Introduction followed by a string of behavioural questions weaved around exhibition of leadership principles in my previous roles. Questions were like – 'Was there ever a scenario where….?' The interviewer also picked on some work-ex points from my resume and asked questions around those.
Question – What is your favorite app? Why? Anything you don't like about it? Follow up question on success metrics/KPIs.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Mostly behavioral/situational questions and discussion on resume.
Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Cracking the PM Interview; went through Amazon's leadership principles.
Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Make sure you have gone through every Leadership Principle and have a short story prepared around it.

Anmol Kumar (Amazon)

Workex: 24 months, Software Developer and DevOps Engineer
Education Background: B.Tech. in Computer Engineering

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Workex Required: 0-5 years
Relevant workex not necessary

PM Topics Covered: Behavioural, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No GD/Case submissions/tests etc. Only interviews.
Interview rounds and their details?
Two interview rounds, ~ 45 mins each.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. First round consisted of resume-based questions, guesstimates, and HR questions.
Second round was around how you've demonstrated Amazon Leadership Principles in real-world situations and HR questions.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Used the following resources.

- ICON's guesstimates for the structure for solving guesstimates
- 'Cracking the PM Interview' by Gayle Laakmann McDowell

- 'Decode and Conquer' by Lewis C Lin
- 'The PM Process' by Sigma
- Favourite app/website: why is it favourite, stand-out features, feature improvements, market size estimation, competitors
- Go through Amazon Leadership Principles and ensure you have specific instances where you exhibited them from your professional/academic life.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Be authentic in the instances you point out from your life. Top priority to be given to Amazon Leadership Principles and guesstimates preparation.

Ananya Ghosh (AWS Consulting)

Workex: 26 Months, Software Engineer, Dell Technologies
Education Background: CSE, KIIT, 2014-18

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Majority of the shortlisted candidates had relevant work-ex.

PM Topics Covered: Product Execution, Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Entirely driven by work experience & situational questions

1. Briefly describe 3 scenarios in your work experience where you used the Amazon Leadership Principles. How integral was your role in the scenario and what were the metrics you used to measure your success in the role?
2. If you were to launch a product which option, would you place more emphasis on?
    - Launching on time by eliminating a few features
    - Delaying the launch but retaining all features

   Justify the cost benefit analysis you would make in each case.

They were convinced with my answers and did not probe any further. The second round had the following questions:

1. You have experience working during a high-pressure Black Friday sales season. How did you handle the technicalities as well as the communication aspects of the process? How many teams did you liaison with and what was your role?
2. You must be having shortlists for the Product Management roles from other companies. Why Amazon?

After this it was more about my extra curriculars and why I would be a good cultural fit for Amazon.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Mostly behavioral/situational questions and discussion on resume.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. Cracking the PM Interview, Decode and Conquer, Sigma's PM Process; went through Amazon's leadership principles.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Make sure you have gone through every Leadership Principle and have a short story prepared around it.

Saurabh Sachan (AWS Consulting)

Workex: 3 years as Architecture Validation Engineer at ARM Embedded Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Education Background: B.Tech, ECE, NITK Surathkal 2013-17

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?

Ans. There was a requirement of minimum 2 years of work-ex.

Relevant work-ex is not necessary as such but having a technical background surely helps.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?

Ans. The first step was resume shortlisting followed by a test. This test was common for Amazon and AWS. The test was a two phased online assessment. The first part is a simulation game wherein you are put in the shoes of manager from different profiles. As far as I can remember, it cut across the four profiles of finance, product, marketing, and operations. The simulation game is quite interesting and throws real life problems at you for which you need to decide the course of action. This assessment was clearly one of the best and most interactive ones that I got to experience during the summers. The simulation is followed by a psychometric assessment which is largely like the psychometric assessments that you would be giving. The candidates for the interview will be shortlisted on the basis of the performance in these assessments and slotted into the profiles as per the performance in the simulation exercise.

Interview rounds and their details?

There were two rounds of interviews that I had to give. The details are as follows:

Round 1: It started off with a normal tell me about yourself etc. type questions. Then the interviewer went on to go through my resume wherein I was questioned on some of the projects that I undertook. A specific problem statement that I worked on was picked up and that was turned into a product design question, basically a typical product management interview question. The interview ended with "why this role" and "why you" type of questions. This round went on for around 30 minutes.

Post the round 1, the interviewer gives the feedback to the HR and based on the performance in the round 1, the second round is scheduled.

Round 2: The round 2 has a different interviewer and it again started with basic tell me about yourself, why amazon, why this role type of questions. From there on it moved to the typical Amazon Leadership Principles based questions. Amazon even sends you resources to read up from before the interview. This is basically the make-or-break round, and they will test you properly. For Amazon, having the cultural fit is of utmost importance and hence there is one round of interview dedicated to test the candidate on that. This round went on for 45 minutes for me.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?

Ans. The round 1 questions were mostly technical and resume centric with a flavour of product management.

The round 2 questions were to test the cultural fit and hence had a flavour of HR to it. They were mostly centred around situations that you have encountered in the past and see how you acted upon them. The structure of the interview is to mostly judge your managerial capabilities in the difficult situations that might arise in an actual scenario.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. The resources that I referred included:

- Preparatory material provided by Sigma
- STAR method related materials forwarded by Amazon
- Leadership principles related document forwarded by Amazon
- Mock interviews conducted by Sigma

Additionally, I referred to the product management material prepared by IIM Ahmedabad to prepare for the product management profile in general.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Most of the cultural fit interviews are designed for the purpose of stress testing the individual and assessing if the candidate can chart the right course of action. Amazon leaders firmly believe in the leadership principles and hence understanding them as well as knowing how to apply them is extremely critical to crack the second round.

Overall, I would say, confidence is the key to cracking any interview, irrespective of the profile. Being honest is extremely important. No one likes a candidate who beats around the bush and as much as we think we can get away with it, it become pretty evident. Know your

resume upside down, each point, every number and you should be able to justify what you have put it on that one pager. It is absolutely alright to not know an answer, they are not looking for a know-it-all. What matters is your approach to a problem, your mindset and keeping your calm if your interview turns out to be a stress interview. Prepare well, believe in yourself, and you will come out of the process with flying colors. All the best!

Sprinklr

Designation	Summer Intern
Roles & Responsibilities	Working with Sprinklr - the B2B SaaS application helping brands manage their social media Working on projects as part of the day-to-day work of product teams Taking ownership of assigned project Complete end to end execution of projects, getting stakeholders inputs, research and focus on end results.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Experiences

Naveen H

Workex: 4 years, as a developer in Zoho
Education Background: Engineer, Computer Science, SSN College of Engineering, Chennai

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. There were no restrictions, but some work-ex was preferred.

PM Topics Covered: Product Execution, Product Strategy, Behavioural, Metrics, App Critique

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No, resume shortlisting and interviews.

Interviews
Three rounds, all eliminative. Took around 1 and a half hours.

Round 1: Technical and situational questions

- Basic intro first – asked to follow up about work done
- Resume point mentioned about user retention and churn – question about ways to identify customers who are going to churn. How can it be pre-empted?
- Amazon wants to get into actual gold or silver jewellery – what are the things they need to consider?
- Situation – There is a customer escalation and there is some urgent work asked by the CTO. How will you prioritize?
- Question about why I left my job after 4 years and want to work with Sprinklr now.

Round 2: Freer flowing round

Round was conducted by two IIM B Alums who were very friendly and cheerful.

- Basic introduction
- Asked about what the ideal interview scenario was – what would I like to talk about.
  I chose to talk about mental health and my NGO working on mental health.
- Questions centered around the mental health space and what our NGO did. Asked to name a particular app in the mental health space.
  I spoke about an app we ourselves had made – asked to explain the working of it.
- Asked about results and how to measure – what kind of metrics to be used.
- Asked a small profitability case related to a stationery store making losses – just to check thought process.

Round 3: HR

- Introduction
- Why do you want to join Sprinklr what do you bring to the table?
- What was responsibility during workex, relationship with manager there.
- Asked about relocation and if comfortable moving to Gurgaon.
- Rapid fire – questions like word that describes you, one strength, weakness and generic questions like that.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?

Ans. Combination of behavioral and case based. Looked at metrics as a key factor in questions.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. Sigma prep book, Cracking the PM Interview, The PM Interview (by Lewis C Lin who wrote Decode and Conquer).

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Keep the conversation going, keep walking them through what you know. Specific to Sprinklr, go through their values and what they focus on. Questions tend to come from parts of your resume to start off.

Shailesh Sharma

Workex: Software Development Engineer – Intel (2017-2019) & Senior Software Engineer – Juniper Networks (2019 - 2020)

Education Background: Btech IIT Kanpur EE

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No workex restriction. No relevant workex but companies seem to shortlist people having bavkground in software engineering or btech in CSE.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No.

Interview rounds and their details?
First round:
What are your hobbies, pick one of them and ask to build an app for it. Further ask to monetize the same app. [Talked about Crickheros and monetize the same]

Second round:
Who do you think is the biggest competitor of Amazon ? what should Amazon do to tackle the same [Talked about Facebook and how it is a biggest competitor of Amazon]
Since I mentioned Facebook , they further asked to build one feature that should go in production in next release.

Third round [HR]:
Asked about why product management ? Ask about conflicting situation ? What is something different in you from others ?

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Technical and HR.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Resource shared by Placecomm.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Be confident and articulate.

AppDynamics

Designation	Program Manager Intern
Job Description	You'll nurture a piece of our product portfolio and be part of our team that is fostering its growth. As a Senior Product Manager, your role will be to understand the needs of our enterprise customers and guide and coordinate a team of designers and engineers to deliver a product that has a transformative impact for those customers. You will have the opportunity – and the challenge – to think deeply about the direction of our product, and to work with a team to see it come alive. In this role, you will: • Own and guide the product vision and strategy for critical parts of our product portfolio • Develop empathy for our customers and field teams so that you understand our customers and their needs. You will articulate those needs within AppDynamics and lead product initiatives that build solutions tailored to meet those needs as they evolve • Collaborate with engineering, sales and design to solve customer problems and motivate our teams to ship quality product in a sustainable, enjoyable team environment • Achieve a balance between the various demands of the organization and its customers as you prioritize your backlog • Educate internal groups and customers about your roadmap in order to communicate direction and gather feedback
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	1

Experiences

Arika Roy

Workex: 35 months
Education Background: BTech in electronics and communications from NIT Allahabad

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No restriction. Although workex was preferred.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics, Behavioural, Product Strategy, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. 1 case submission round. We were asked to choose between 2 questions 1 - To launch a online learning platform for large enterprises. 2 - To launch a video conferencing application. They mentioned that they weren't looking for a creative idea, just the structure, basic communication skills etc.

Interview rounds and their details?

There were 2 rounds of interview.
First round: The interviewer did not ask me to introduce myself and went straight into the product design question. I was asked to design a restaurant aggregator with features that differentiate it in the market. So, I identified the different users, and selected the user persona of an unmarried person named X, living with friends. I identified the pain-point of being indecisive about selecting a cuisine and getting everyone on-board with the order. For solutioning I thought of working through that by providing a visual medium. I suggested offering different cuisines from a market by optimising delivery distances between 2 or more restaurants. The interviewer liked it and asked if I could think of any gamification feature. I thought of VR where users can experience themselves, looking at a certain cuisine being made and if that could act as a 'nudge' to help them decide. He then asked me the relevant metrics to track. And finally asked if I had questions. I had done extensive company research and had prepared 2 questions for the company and the type of work they did. One of them was introducing a new feature to their product and the interviewer informed me that it was on their product roadmap.

Second Round: More of a behavioural round, where the interviewer and I were just in a normal conversation. He asked me what product I designed in round 1. He then asked me questions about college, studies and how we generally manage group projects. He asked me, how to approach someone who doesn't reply to your messages (The answer is keep pinging them and then escalate or bypass. Depends). He also asked me the go to market strategy, guesstimate the market size for user adoption and important metrics to track for the product design question. He also asked me what sort of inputs one can get from the sales team. Towards the end of the call, I was given the offer.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. No resume related questions were asked. Although that solely depends on the interviewer.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Cracking the PM interview. Tech podcasts - Tech crunch, The product podcast.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Do your company research. Practice your CIRCLES. And think about all the improvements you can make in every app on your phone and discuss it with your friends. Even, the mature

products, like Google Maps, Photos, Spotify, YouTube. Every product can always be improved both to generate revenue and increase engagement. Don't mix and match. Try to be original in your approach. Once, you get your pain point right, designing features are a cakewalk. Don't stress if your feature is not groundbreaking. Nobody comes up with groundbreaking ideas sitting alone in a room in a day. (Not even Steve Jobs). Finally, practice your metrics. Be confident.

United Health Group- Optum

Designation	Product Intern
Job Description	This position would give the selected individual an opportunity to work on a live customer project in the healthcare space. The selected individual would be the part of a team that is involved in defining a solution and executing the same for one of our key stakeholders. • Work with the business to identify, analyze, document the business, recommending business priorities, and advising business on options, risks, and solutions. • Data analysis understand, interpret, validate, manipulate data using excel and other tools, and present conclusions and recommendations. • Qualitative analysis using business management concepts and strategy definition.
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview
Candidates selected	5

Experiences

Neeraj Rajendra

Workex: 3 years, Software Engineer, Avaya
Education Background: Electronics and Communication Engineering, SJCE Mysuru

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Don't remember any such restrictions on Work Experience.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics, App Critique, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No GD/case submission/tests – direct shortlist from resume

Interview rounds and their details?
3 interview rounds – 2 technical, 1 HR
Some of the questions asked:

- What do you know about UHG Optum, Why UHG Optum?
- Propose a new product in the healthcare segment – do competitor analysis, value offering
- What are the stages and stakeholders involved in product management? Assume you have to launch a new product from scratch and mention all the steps
- If you want to have to redesign an existing product, what analyses would you need to do, what all stakeholders you need to convince?
- What success metric would you use to gauge whether a new feature you suggested is useful for customers? If customers are not utilizing that feature, what would you do to increase user engagement for that feature?
- Can you suggest a product which could help hospitals manage COVID patients better?
- What is your favorite mobile application? What you like, what you don't like? What new feature you would add?
- Give a guesstimate of number of Domino's pizza outlets in India.
- Why are you a good fit for product management? What are the qualities a product manager needs to have? List such qualities you already have and those that you need to learn.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Product design, guesstimates, HR & questions about product management, no resume-based questions.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. ICON casebook for guesstimates, Cracking the PM interview, preparation about resume points, had not done company-specific preparation.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Be calm and cheerful throughout, ask for time to think instead of trying to immediately answer, read about product management profile and be thorough with what a product manager does.

Amol Nandgaonkar

Workex: 47 Months, CapGemini
Education Background: Engineer, RJIT

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?

Ans. There wasn't any restriction for work experience, but trend was seen with relevant work experience applicants getting shortlisted. My take on it was that IT experience was preferred by the company.

PM Topics Covered: Product Execution, Behavioural, App Critique

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. There were no GD/CD/submissions.

There were 2 rounds in total:

- Round 1: This round was focused more on my work ex. In detail questions were asked specific to my resume and keywords I used in the resume (Scrum, Agile etc). They were looking for depth in the answers. I was also given a small Case to solve on the spot.
- Round 2: This round was more of a company fit assessment. Questions were asked on my previous leadership roles, Ethical Dilemma questions, Situational/ Priority assessment questions were asked.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. HR based: Company fit questions/ Ethical dilemma

- Technical: Questions based on my technical role in work ex.
- Resume based: Few questions were asked on the points in my resume.
- Case: "What is your favorite application in day-to-day use? What new features would you suggest to improve that app?

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. All Sigma provided material: Case book, Decode and Conquer etc.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Be thorough with your work experience and resume. The material provided by sigma was enough to cover the rest aspects of the interview. All the Best!

Adobe

Designation	Program Management Intern
Job Description	• Primary and secondary research to identify user needs and emerging trends • Understanding competitive, partner landscape and generating actionable insights

	• You will pitch and validate new product ideas for internal and external partners • Contributing to Product, Go to Market vision and strategy • Building requirement documents and specs, detailing out user journey, use cases. • Collaborate with Design and Engineering to create proof of concept, actual implementation
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Experiences

Smriti Narayan

Workex: SDE, Microsoft, 2 Years
Education Background: CSE, PESIT Bangalore

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. None, But from the looks of it, some work ex was preferred.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Execution

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. None, only shortlisting based on resume
Interview rounds and their details?

- Only 1 interview round
- Mainly structured around why the interest to be a Product Manager.
- Why Adobe, what interests me about Adobe, (specifically Adobe Creative Cloud as creativity related pointers were mentioned in my resume)
- Work ex related questions – around A/B testing, User experience and Scale of products in large organizations (Microsoft and Adobe)
- Followed by one problem solving question around extending Whatsapp for Enterprise users and incorporating the use of Whatsapp in businesses and organizations.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. HR (introduction, interests etc.)

- Resume Based (Based on impact pointers mentioned under Work Experience in User Experience Handling)
- Problem Solving (Extending Whatsapp for Enterprise)

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. A LOT of YouTube videos from Exponent (almost used as a holy grail)

- Prep material shared by Sigma within campus

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Show the interviewer that you are curious when you are, and you do not know something when you don't. Ask them questions and use their answers in your further conversation to get to understand the company better and at the same time, put forth your true self.

PayU

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Building relationships with different people across all business organizations while exploring different functional areas of PayU! • As a Product Manager, you will partner with internal stakeholders to understand new feature needs, building out the road map and vision to bring those features to life. • Working with business partners to write designs for features through understanding other teams' needs. • Driving and owning the vision and strategy for your area of expertise. • Shipping your ideas and building out features that may go live on our site
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Experiences

Niranjan

Workex: 2 years as Data/Product Analyst
Education Background: IIT Guwhati, Chemical Engineering

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No Such Requirements

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No, direct interviews
Interview rounds and their details?
Only one round around 30 mins.

- Basic introduction – tell me about yourself. Why product and what led you to take this. Spoke about workex and motivation. Asked about previous work details and role. Name two situations where you thought out of the box. Since previous work was in edtech, asked if you would be ok to switch from edtech to fintech.
- What kind of product worked on, then went into depth about situation, to verify claims and knowledge.
- Asked about knowledge of fintech sector and what idea you had. Then they explained the product they were hiring for.
- Case - developing a platform similar to CricInfo, design and envision product from scratch. First looked at what the product is, then USP, then went into what the product is, differentiation from CricInfo, then monetization. Then asked about how to get users on board – SEO, backlinks etc.
- Where do you see yourself and what is your long term vision.

Overall wanted to get to know you and your work, then look at thought process.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Resume based and to get to know person better and one case.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Didn't do much prep due to experience being similar.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Know what you have done from a product aspect, self-reflect and think of what you could do better etc. Be sure of what they say from all angles.

Samsung Research

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Drive product vision and strategy in the team. • Build product concept and be owner of all product requirements. • Build and Communicate product value proposition to end users, partners and other stakeholders. • Analyze market, understand users/ personas – in the global as well as Indian context. • Know the competitive landscape and be single voice on product direction.

	• Drive prioritization to enable team to focus and deliver most important features in a timely manner. • Create product requirements and work with UX/Engineers for Interaction design for all features. • Communicate with all internal stakeholders (Senior Management, Engineers, Business Teams …) • Define success metrics and analyze product performance.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Experiences

Dhanvi Laxmana Kamath

Workex: R&D Engineer, Synopsys India Pvt. Ltd. 25 months; Analyst, Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu India LLP 9 months

Education Background: Engineer, Computer Science, Govt. Model Engineering College, Ernakulam

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. There were no restrictions on work-ex, but it was generally preferred.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Resume Shortlisting and GD. GD topic was 'The future of IT firms in India'.
Interview rounds and their details?
1 round. 20 minutes. 2 members in interview panel, one of them an IIMB alum.
He started off the interview with 'Tell me about yourself'. There were some follow-up questions on the work-ex. I also mentioned an IEEE paper I had co-authored which dealt with using emotions and gestures for controlling electrical devices and how it could be used by persons with disabilities. I was asked to explain it in detail. Then there was a follow up question on this. 'How will this system be tested and what metrics will be used to measure its success?'
Another question was 'Imagine if you are a product manager at Amazon. Consider the shopping website where the top portion of the landing page shows us various deals, discounts etc. What metrics would you use to measure the success only this part of the page. Why?'
There were some Samsung specific questions. 'Which smartphone do you use? Have you used any of the Galaxy store apps?'

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Situation Based, Metrics.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. IIMA Prod Man Prep book, Sigma prep book, The PM Interview (by Lewis C Lin who wrote Decode and Conquer).

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Use 'tell me about yourself' to give extra details about specific points in your resume that you want to highlight.

- If you find difficulty in understanding a question, repeat whatever part you have understood in your own words. The interviewer will help you fill up the gaps and understand the rest.
- If you get a Samsung shortlist, try out the Galaxy app store, search engine. Will help you find talking points.

Oracle

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Understand the current scope of ERP software and identify the potential areas of improvement using latest technologies like Machine Learning and Block chain. • Define and document feature requirements, User journey and multiple use cases. • Design UX for identified features that are due for next release by collaborating with design team • Drive the product development process by liaising with multiple stakeholders on a daily basis. • Identify bugs and track closure of them by liaising with engineering team • Define test Strategy and monitor the testing process for upcoming releases. • Define metrics and monitor them during release
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Experiences

Sai Teja Rapelle

Workex: 4years, Consultant at Infosys

Education Background: B.Tech CSE at SNIST College, Hyderabad

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No restriction as such wrt background or experience.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, System Design, Metrics

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. A test is conducted for shortlisting. Test consisted of around 40 MCQs related to finance domain. Most of the questions are basic concepts of Financial Accounting and Corporate Finance subjects.
Interview rounds and their details?
2 rounds
Round 1: 3 Panelists

- Basic Intro and questions about all work ex points mentioned in the resume.
- Questions about Cloud and ERP software. (basics only)
- Some HR questions on leadership and situation-based questions

Round 2: 1 panelist

- More grilling round about product design questions.
- Asked questions in detail about my past work experience.
- Questions about metrics related to a particular feature
- Why oracle? Why PM?

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. All types of questions are covered across the rounds. Also, questions varied according to the background and previous workex of the candidate.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Typical Prod man prep like PM cases, tech related news etc. Also, knowing basic details about the company, ERP software and about the role can help.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Bring your past experiences to your answers and show them your passion to learn new things.

Amagi

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Pitch new product ideas based on primary and secondary research • Improve existing products and create product requirement documents for the features • Coordinate with engineers and sales teams to validate ideas.

	• Detail out user stories on product management tools • Perform competitive benchmarking of existing products
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	4

Experiences

Sajmal Yousef

Workex: 2 years, as an SDE at JP Morgan Chase & Co.
Education Background: Engineer, Computer Science, NIT Calicut

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. There were no restrictions but work-ex was an added advantage.

PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy, App Critique, Root Cause Analysis, Metrics

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Yes. A case submission on 'a go to market plan for a new product in Ad-Tech space' was required.
Interview rounds and their details?

Two rounds, all eliminative. Took around 1 hour.
Round 1: Technical and situational questions

- Conducted by an IIM B alum
- Basic intro and work done.
- Presented the case submission prepared.
- Some follow up questions on the case
- Asked about what I knew about Amagi and their products.
- Situation – How would you improve Netflix?
  I spoke about how Netflix can introduce recommendations from friends.

Round 2: Interview by Product Lead

- Asked questions on side projects mentioned in resume and its feasibility
- Situation- Amazon has a calculator app and the sales has been dropping. Do a root cause analysis

Majorly checked the thought process

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Combination of behavioral and case based. Looked at metrics as a key factor in questions.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Sigma prep book, Cracking the PM Interview, The PM Interview (by Lewis C Lin who wrote Decode and Conquer), IIM-A case book and https://www.productmanagementexercises.com/

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Keep the conversation going, keep talking about your thought process. Specific to Amagi, though thorough understanding of their product is not required, having some idea gives a good impression.

Airtel

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• The incumbent will be allocated strategic project/s across one of the mentioned functions, where he will be expected to understand the business concern, analyze the problem and work with stakeholders to come up with a solution while keeping customer at the center. • Work on high-impact projects under the guidance of proficient leaders -understand, analyze and suggest implementable recommendations concerning the project.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	1

Experiences

Saiksha Shetty
Workex: 37 months, Senior Software Engineer, Samsung R&D Bangalore
Education Background: BTech, Computer science engineering, VJTI

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No, I don't think so.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No
Interview rounds and their details?
The hiring process comprised of only 1 interview round, the panel consisted of a Product Manager and HR.

The initial questions were based on understanding the prior work experience and why product management. Then as my previous work-ex was in smartphone cameras, I was asked 'what would be the future of Smartphone Cameras and design a product for the same'. Also, asked a guesstimate to 'determine the number of vehicles parked at Airport on a day'. Then there were questions asking about 'Why Airtel?', 'Products of Airtel', and general questions on flexibility of location and project domain.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. A few Behavioral questions, guesstimates were ask and questions on previous work ex.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Nothing specific- notes from company PPT, and company website.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Prepare for guesstimates and product design questions related to your previous work-ex or area of interest. Read about the different businesses of Airtel.

FinIQ

Designation	Product Management/Finance Intern
Job Description	Multi-dimensional role which gives the interns equal exposure to Financial Markets, Business Management and Technology. Interns will be assigned to live projects and will be working on diverse roles and assignments in • Pricing Mathematics for Financial Products • Product Management • Business Development
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	5

Experiences

Ishank Agarwal

Workex: 30 months
Education Background: BTech, Mechanical Engineering, IIT Kanpur

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?

Ans. The company didn't have any work-ex restrictions as such. No relevant workex required in my case atleast. I am from a mechanical background with no financial knowledge before IIMB.

PM Topics Covered: Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. There was direct resume shortlisting and then interviews
Interview rounds and their details?
There were two interview rounds:

- First was more like a HR round where they discussed about the challenges one might face at the company and ask if I was willing to work in such an environment. Otherwise, this round was pretty chill. They asked me about my hobbies and discussion let to Avengers movie series. One question from their side was 'Give a different ending to Avengers Endgame'.

- Second round was a slightly financial round. They asked basic finance questions like what CAPM is, and NPV.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Some finance questions. Nothing otherwise. The interview was pretty chill

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Just revise your FA and CF courses. I think rest everything will be okay

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. FinIQ was looking for students with good JEE and CAT scores. So if you do have good scores in these exams, do apply to FinIQ. The internship was a really good experience and you will get experience in various different fields. Regarding the interview, I believe there won't be much preparation needed for interview apart from Finance. Just be confident about yourself and you fitting into the FinIQ culture.

Infoedge

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Develop and define product roadmaps and feature concepts • Work with the engineering team to communicate release goals and be a part of product lifecycle. • Interface with Marketing for inputs on consumer marketing activities. • Interface with Sales team to identify product gaps and evangelize new features for products selling.

	• Understand Customer segments and define product pricing. • Own product performance and conduct periodic performance reviews. • Creative ideation and articulation of ideas. A typical day consists of: • Market Landscaping & Competitive Analysis • Define and Measure Key product Metrics • Develop Go-to-market Strategy
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	4

Experiences

Akshay Kedare

Workex: 4 yrs, Bewakoof.com, Core Team (Ops & Tech)
Education Background: Chemical Engg. IITB'16

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Even though I was from an e-commerce background, none of the other interns had similar workex. There were no workex restrictions as such and relevant workex didn't seem to be necessary.

PM Topics Covered: Product Execution, Behavioural, Guesstimates, Metrics

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No pre-processes, shortlist was resume based.

Interview rounds and their details?

There was just one interview round with two members on the panel. One of them was the HR recruiter partner and the other was the Business Vertical India Head. Most questions were asked by the business head.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Interview started off with introduction. They were intrigued by my workex and asked questions around that in the resume. This went on for some time. Then was asked about whether I was aware of Info Edge and all its subsidiary businesses. I told them about Naukri as it was the only business I knew. So there were questions on Naukri as a platform (marketplace)

with recruiters and jobseekers on it's platform. Interviewers were trying to test critical thinking ability, common sense, general awareness of business functions. I was asked what the 3 metrics would be that you would track on a regular basis to keep updated about the progress of your business unit at Naukri. This involved some deductive and logical thinking along with knowledge of business metrics and ratios.

After this I was asked to estimate the total number of rental brokers in India. The interview mostly felt like a conversation. There were some questions on the line of how you would manage your business in difficult times like covid. What I think the interviewers liked was quick & innovative thinking while answering their questions. In hindsight, my interview wasn't like a typical PM interview, where you talk about product improvements and use frameworks to solve them.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Standard prep books given by placement cell and Sigma. PM Cases and videos on YouTube where PM solve cases live while demonstrating their thinking and applications of the frameworks.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Confidence, general awareness, critical thinking, and good communication – generic traits that would help you in any interview is what I think worked here. Though recruiters from different verticals within info edge might approach the process differently, so it would help to be thorough with your frameworks and other PM prep as well.

Walmart Labs

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Exhibit strong domain understanding and work closely with Business partners to create customer delight. • Execute on the product management problem statement by applying business knowledge and strong customer empathy. • Develops and champions a world class product vision and strategy for a product team managing multiple products. • Understand the strategy and execution of multiple projects in an Agile Environment for Product Management including product requirements.

	• Ensures alignment of product vision, strategy, and status with the executive leadership team's priorities and vision as well as team's stakeholders. • Ensures business needs are being met. • Define metrics and monitor them during release
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	6

Experiences

Mona Rishi Boga

Workex: 57 months

Education Background: BTech, Computer science engineering

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?

Ans. Minimum experience of 2 years.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?

Ans. 1st shortlisted people has to do a case submission. Shortlisting for interview was done based on our case submissions.

Interview rounds and their details?

Case submission,2 rounds of interviews.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?

Ans. Case, Resume points, link some answers to the resume point. For example, I was asked if I had done taken any initiative in my work-ex, which I answered and linked it to a resume point

Pre-process: Case submission

We were asked to design a feature enhancement UPI app to increase user engagement

Round 1 :

- Case based interview
- Feature enhancement for a automatic cooking product
- Also asked GTM and marketing plan for the same product.

Grilled a lot on details

Round 2:

Work-ex related questions, Resume based questions and more focus on metrics

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Decode and Conquer – case prep
https://www.productmanagementexercises.com
Exponent YouTube channel
TechCrunch for technology news.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Don't only prep for PM cases, they might ask GTM as well. So, at least practice few consult cases of each type
Guesstimates are must. Useful in case submissions as well to estimate market size
It is ok to take 10 min to collect your points. Be cool and keep telling the interviewer what you are thinking during case interviews. Make it a conversation.

Vishal Pandey

Workex: 2 years as a Software Engineer at Fidelity Investments
Education Background: BTech, Computer science engineering, MNNIT Allahabad

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. 2+ years of Work Experience required.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Root Cause Analysis, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. *Case Study submission*: Launch a new UPI based payments app in an already crowded market with other large players already established in the market, recommend a list of features which you think will help your product differentiate from the competition and win market share
Interview rounds and their details?
Varied for candidates. I had one round of interview that lasted for approximately an hour. The interviewer focused on my background and Work Experience initially.

Then there was a case to be solved: You are the CEO of a technological solutions start-up and have been approached by the RTO of Bangalore to solve the problem that they are facing. There is overcrowding of vehicles in Bangalore, vehicle owners are unable to find parking spaces, and this has led to too many vehicles illegally parked at wrong places. There was also guesstimate in between to come up with the number of two and four wheelers in Bangalore.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?

Ans. Resume based questions related to my work experience (15 minutes), 1 case to be solved and a small guesstimate within the case (40 minutes).

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Sigma prep book, Cracking the PM Interview.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Be confident while answering, know your resume thoroughly, show stakeholder management and think from the customers' perspective. Amazon's leadership principles help in all Product Management interviews.

Atlassian

Designation	Product Management Intern
Process Candidates selected	Resume Shortlisting + Interview 2

Experiences

Yamuna Murugadoss

Workex: 4 years, as Associate Software Engineer in Bosch
Education Background: Engineer, Electrical, Bannari Amman Institute of Technology

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Minimum 2 Years.

PM Topics Covered: App Critique, Behavioural, Guesstimates

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No, resume shortlisting and interview.
Interview rounds and their details?
One round. 2 members. 40 minutes.

- In depth questioning on workex.
- 'What is your biggest achievement?' I mentioned a script I had written at work which came to be used across departments. Follow ups on that.
- 'Can you tell me the revenue of YouTube?'
- 'Which is your favourite product. Why? How to enhance it?'

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Guesstimate, resume based.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Cracking the PM Interview, Decode and Conquer, The PM Interview, Product design questions online.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. While using Cracking the PM Interview, try and apply some of the concepts to the organization which you have worked with to understand them better.

Choppa Aditya

Workex: NA
Education Background: CSE, IITM

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No. Relevant Workex is not necessary as they are looking for people from diverse backgrounds, but it would be helpful.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Metrics, Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No.
Interview rounds and their details?
There was only one round. But it was long and had guesstimate, case as well as HR questions
Guesstimate related questions:
Estimate number of pet dogs in Visakhapatnam (my hometown)?
Any additional assumptions I made while arriving at the answer.
Same procedure for all pets (apart from dogs) in Visakhapatnam.
Case related questions:

- If I must develop an app to address this market, what would it be?
- Who are the target customers for this app?
- What will be the go-to market strategy for the same?
- What will be the revenue model?
- What are the KPIs for the developed app?

HR questions:

- What are my strengths?
- Why Product Management after UPSC?
- Any failures and what did you earn from them.
- Why Atlassian?

There were more questions, but I do not remember them.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Most of the questions were based on guesstimates and a case related to it. Resume based questions were focused on in the later part of the interview (when HR questions were asked).

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Prepared from the material shared by sigma. Went through 'Cracking the PM Interview' and 'Decode and Conquer'. I had a general idea of what the company does, but I was not asked any questions specific to the company (except for Why Atlassian?).

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Focus on how two-sided marketplaces work, SaaS and B2B softwares.

Asian Paints-Systems

Designation	Product Management Intern
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	1

Experiences

Dharanie Shankar

Workex: Engineer, Samsung R&D, 3 Years
Education Background: Engineer, CSE, NIT Trichy

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No such restrictions on work Ex.

PM Topics Covered: Behavioural

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. One Round of Interview:

- Tell me about yourself.
- Example of a crisis in Samsung and how you handled it?
- Example of situation where you had to ideate something and bring to superior. Superior did not agree to good idea. How would you implement?
- 6 situations in company, 2 in college.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?

Ans. Mostly Behavioural questions on previous work ex and situations related to challenges and innovation.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. Prepared on Guesstimates, Requirement's analysis related to Product design
Cracking the PM interview. Prepared together.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Start early. Cracking the PM interview – Don't read the first 8 chapters. Directly go to guesstimates. Better to have a partner to practice.

Consulting/IT/Strat

TCS

Designation	Consulting
Job Description	• Develop proof-of-concepts using latest concepts like IoT (internet of Things), Machine learning, etc. • Opportunity to be at the front end of Technology and build products that disrupt the Industry. Work on implementing Next gen technologies. • The role is to own a product or sub-product such as Search, Checkout, and Loyalty and drive the entire product vision, roadmap, customer research, development and continuous improvement. • Have business process understanding and operational experience in core functional areas with desire to create and build custom solutions in the domain. • Prepare the standards and guidelines for technical designing based on various business goals and specific inputs from the clients. • Support organizational changes regarding capability development, restructuring toward product centric team models and transitioning to modern agile SDLC practices. Build strong stakeholder relationships and foster interaction at different levels • Provide standard and custom demos to new product prospects and support new user on boarding and product adoption acting as a bridge between the customers and the product, marketing, and design teams and keep abreast of customer expectations for the products.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	10

Experiences

Priyanshi Verma

Workex: 34 months
Education Background: ECE Engineering

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. Yes, there was a restriction of 36 months of work-ex.

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Yes, there was GD on a general topic and one of the partners himself judged the discussion. He asked if anybody had any questions in the end. Feel free to ask.

Interview rounds and their details?
There was just one interview. Questions were asked from Resume and work-experience.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. My questions were:

- Tell me about yourself
- Since I had mentioned Music as an interest
- Tell me something about your interest in music
- Tell me something about the semi-conductor industry (My work ex.)
- Devise a Go to market strategy for one of the products/solutions. What factors will you consider while formulating a go-to-market strategy
- What problems did you face in your work ex. and how did you tackle those (HR questions)

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Prepare your resume and work-ex well.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Be logical and sound really interested.

Kimberly Clark

Designation	IT Intern
Job Description	• The intern will be assigned a project that is rooted in a live business need, thereby contributing to the learning of the intern, while giving K-C the opportunity to gain from the fresh perspective and original thinking of the intern.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Experiences

Shweta Vavre

Workex: 2 Years of work ex at Deloitte
Education Background: EEE, NIT Trichy

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No, there were no such restrictions.
Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Video Extempore, Topic: If you had to change one thing about your MBA experience, what would it be.
Interview rounds and their details?
Only one round – 45 mins approx.

- Tell me about yourself
- College related – extracurricular related questions
- Work done during work ex – in depth questions. Had done QA, so questions about test cases and processes. Leadership positions during work ex.
- Behavioural and scenario-based questions on leadership. If you had a problem with someone how would you tackle it?
- Why KC, what do you know about KC. Vision and values of KC.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans Resume based questions, HR based, out of every point in the resume.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man/IT interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Nothing specific, resume points in detail and any possible questions from it, calculations for numbers.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Know every line in your resume in detail and be ready to get grilled on it.

Goldman Sachs

Designation	Strat Intern
Job Description	**Designing and developing sophisticated software and systems using proprietary as well as modern web, mobile, and, desktop technologies:** 1)to manage, visualize, and analyze massive sets of market and operational data used in our trading, risk management, and control functions 2)to correctly and efficiently route orders for billions of dollars of securities every day. 3)to allow the ability to represent, transact in and risk manage all of the firm's OTC derivative positions. 4)to distribute computations across tens of thousands of computers. 5)to make use of functional programming paradigm and big data solutions to develop firm's next generation modeling, pricing, and risk management platform 6)to contribute to key open source initiatives – e.g. GSCollections, Project Panama. 7)to build firm's strategic mobile platform
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	4

Experiences

Rishabh Agarwal

Workex: 3 Years work ex at Samsung R&D
Education Background: CSE

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No, there were no such requirements.

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. No.
Interview rounds and their details?
2 rounds

- 1st – CS Tech + Probability questions. CS questions related to arrays, stacks, linked list. Reading Geeks for Geeks Basic (maybe medium) questions should do. Probability questions were simple applications of bayes theorem
- 2nd- Finance. Corporate Finance (CF) questions. Topics include bonds and YTM. They did not have a fixed set of questions, based on your answers they tried to ask you further to test your understanding of it.

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. Technical

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man/IT/Strat interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. Used the following resources

- Geeks for geeks
- CF book is good + I "binge watched" this (7 hour + playlist) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gkoEAPAW7eg&list=PL_KGEFWqEaTBbYDupRektHIMG0G9u-Ru-
- Video no. 41 onwards

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. Brush up CS skills, whatever CF taught so far be clear with it. Rest is luck.

Marico

Designation	IT Intern
Job Description	• The Summer Training at Marico's Pace (STAMP) encourages fresh talent that joins Marico to think like entrepreneurs rather than employees. • Running over a period of 2 months, it is one of the most intensive yet enriching program in the industry. The STAMP program promises you a challenging, enriching and fulfilling experience through two months of internship where you will be working on one of the many interesting and high impact live projects that the organization has to offer. • During this period you will get an opportunity to grow as a professional, solve business cases with your unique approach and reimagine systems and processes. You will have the chance to question status quo, do things differently and come up with innovative solutions. Through-out the program, we have a strong evaluation process in place to ensure that each Summer Trainee is on track. The final review includes a presentation to the Function Head, Business HR and Project Guide. This evaluation is based on the values and cultural elements of the

	organization, to assess their suitability to work as a Future Leader at Marico.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	1

Prashant Bagdia

Workex: 3 Years work ex as a Software Developer
Education Background: CSE, NIT Warangal

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Ans. No work-ex restriction as such. Relevant workex was not necessary, but it's always better and beneficial to have some technical background as the work will require having good grasp of technical details.

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?
Ans. Yes, there was a preliminary test on D2C. Shortlisted candidates after the test were called for GD round.

Interview rounds and their details?
Shortlisted candidates from GD were called for interviews. I had only 1 interview round. The entire interview was focused on my workex. Every project during workex that I listed on my resume was discussed in depth. Then a few HR related questions were also asked(Why Marico, do you think you can fit into an FMCG culture, do you think you can see yourself working at Marico for at least 5 years).

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?
Ans. It was mostly on my workex. All the points that I mentioned under workex were covered in depth. HR questions were also asked. No guesstimates.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?
Ans. The material shared by Sigma, cracking the PM interview book,
and productmanagementexercises.com.

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?
Ans. If you have workex, be thorough with every single point you have written on the work-ex side of your resume. Most of the interviews will revolve around your work-ex.

Natwest

Designation	IT Intern
Job Description	Key responsibility – a) Research on the use of emerging technologies like Blockchain, Open banking, Machine Learning, AI etc. in the banking industry, b) Understand if and how these technologies are leveraged in Natwest and • c) Publish a paper outlining recommendation on how and in which areas can Natwest use these technologies better, in order to increase revenue, reduce cost or enhance customer experience.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview
Candidates selected	2

Anvesh Godavarthi

Workex: Infosys, 21 months

Education Background: B.Tech (Computer Science), Central University Bilaspur

Q1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?

Ans. No, good to have tech experience since it is a tech role

Q2. What is the hiring process? (GD/Case Submission/No of Interview rounds/Duration)?

Ans. No

Interview rounds and their details?

Had only one interview round for about 20 minutes. The interview revolved around resume and general HR questions. Few of the questions asked were as follows:

1. Why NatWest?
2. Why are you interested in technology? Worked on any latest technology?
3. Why do you think you are a fit for this role?
4. Resume based (Worked on a research paper – was asked about the work done)

Q3. What kind of questions were asked in the GD/interview? (HR/Behavioral/resume/product design/cases/guesstimates)?

Ans. Primary focus on HR, resume and company info.

Q4. How did you go about preparing for the Prod Man interviews? (Group study/ Resources)?

Ans. Research about the company and the sector. Be informed about any transformations in the company be it digital or business (like mergers and acquisitions).

Q5. Any tips/suggestions?

Ans. Prepare company info and be thorough with each point in your resume.